

Soderstrand Trip to Sweden



May 31 – June 11 2026

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Kellan West.



Stockholm June 1

The Streets of Gamla Stan, the Old City



The Treasury at the Old Royal Palace

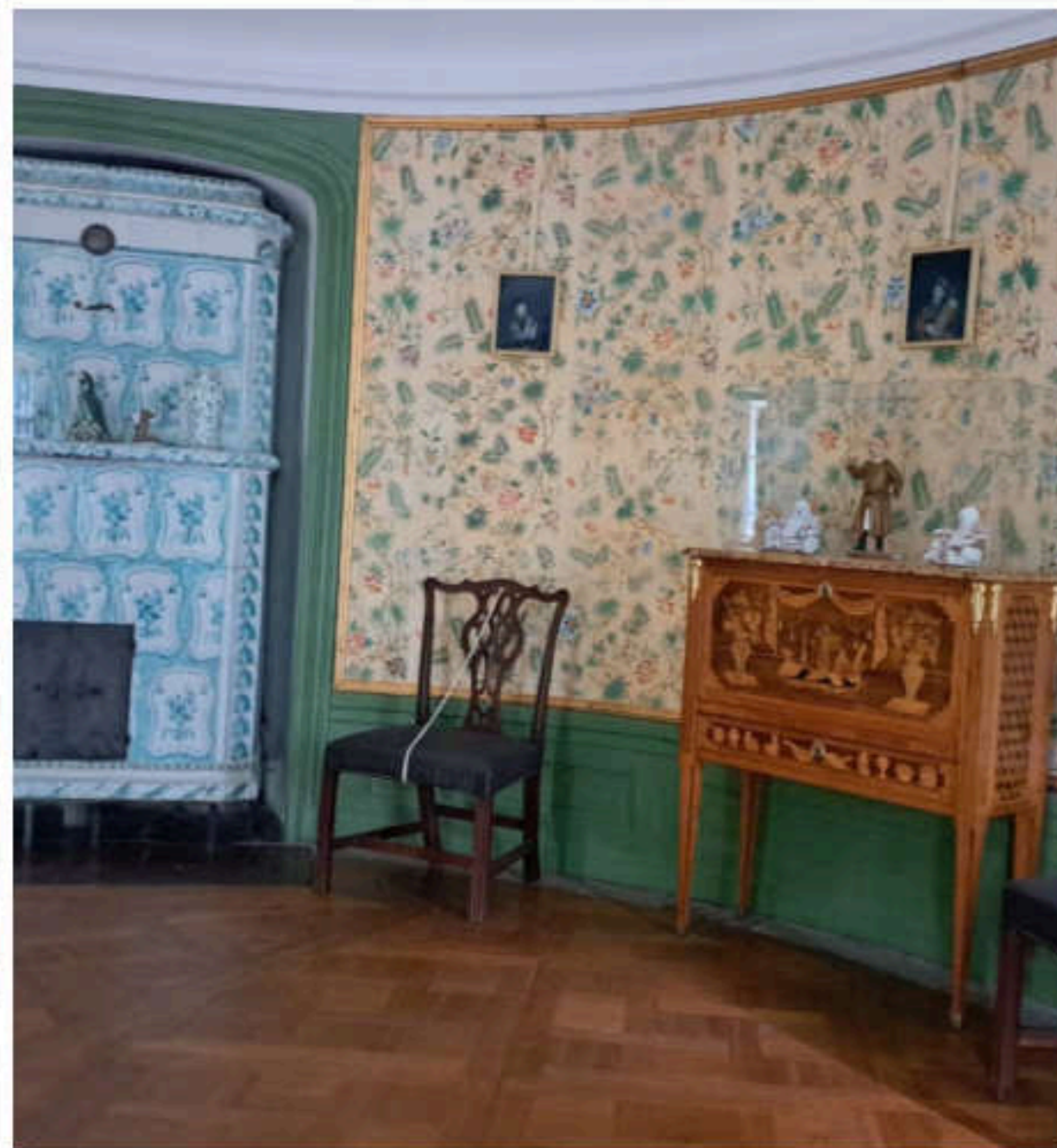
Now a museum with royal artifacts

**June 2, 2025 The
New Royal Palace**



**The Drottningholm
Royal Palace In
Sweden is where the
King and Queen of
Sweden now reside. It
was originally the
Queen's Palace with he
King at the Old Royal
Palace in Gamla Stan**

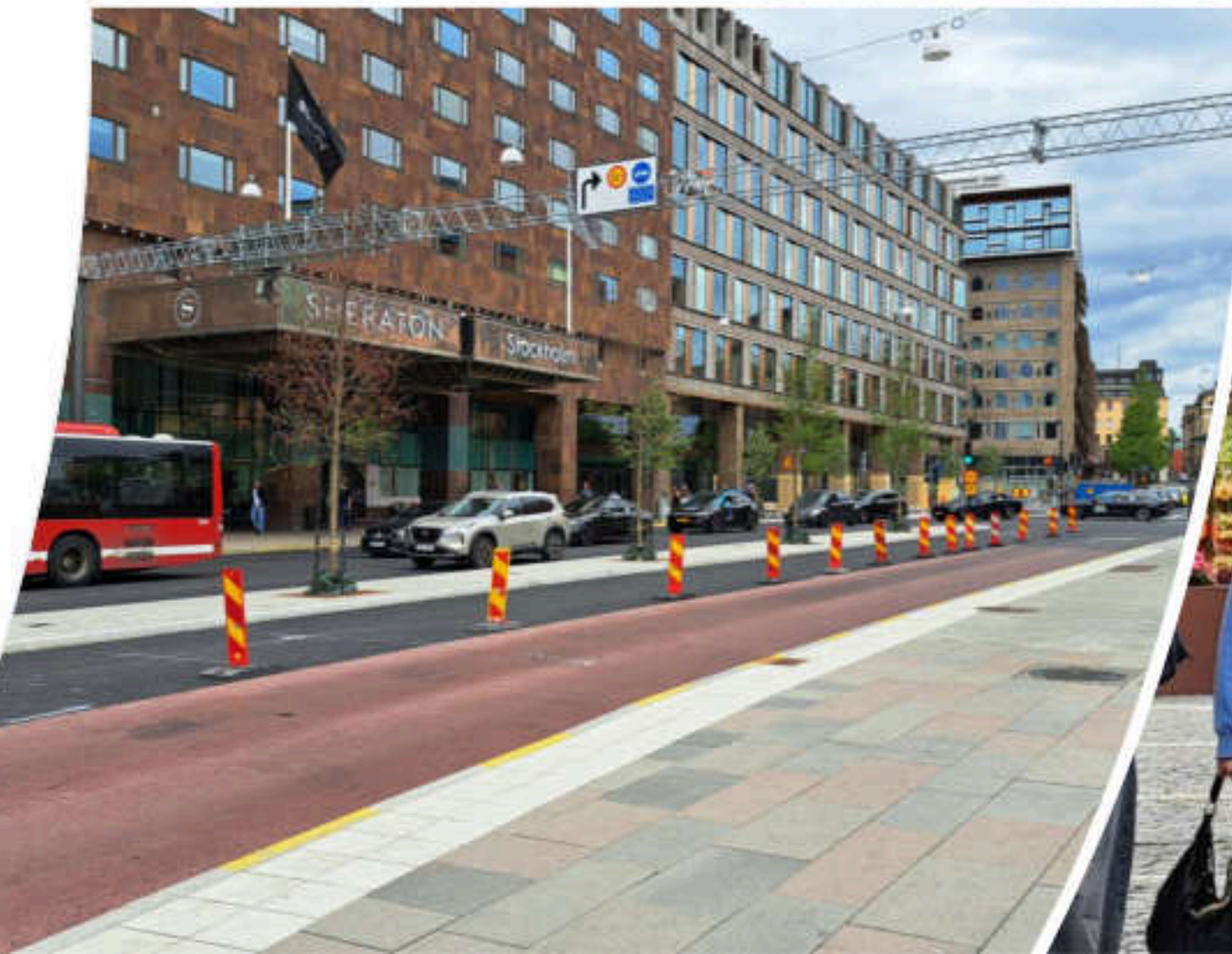




The Drottningholm Royal Palace

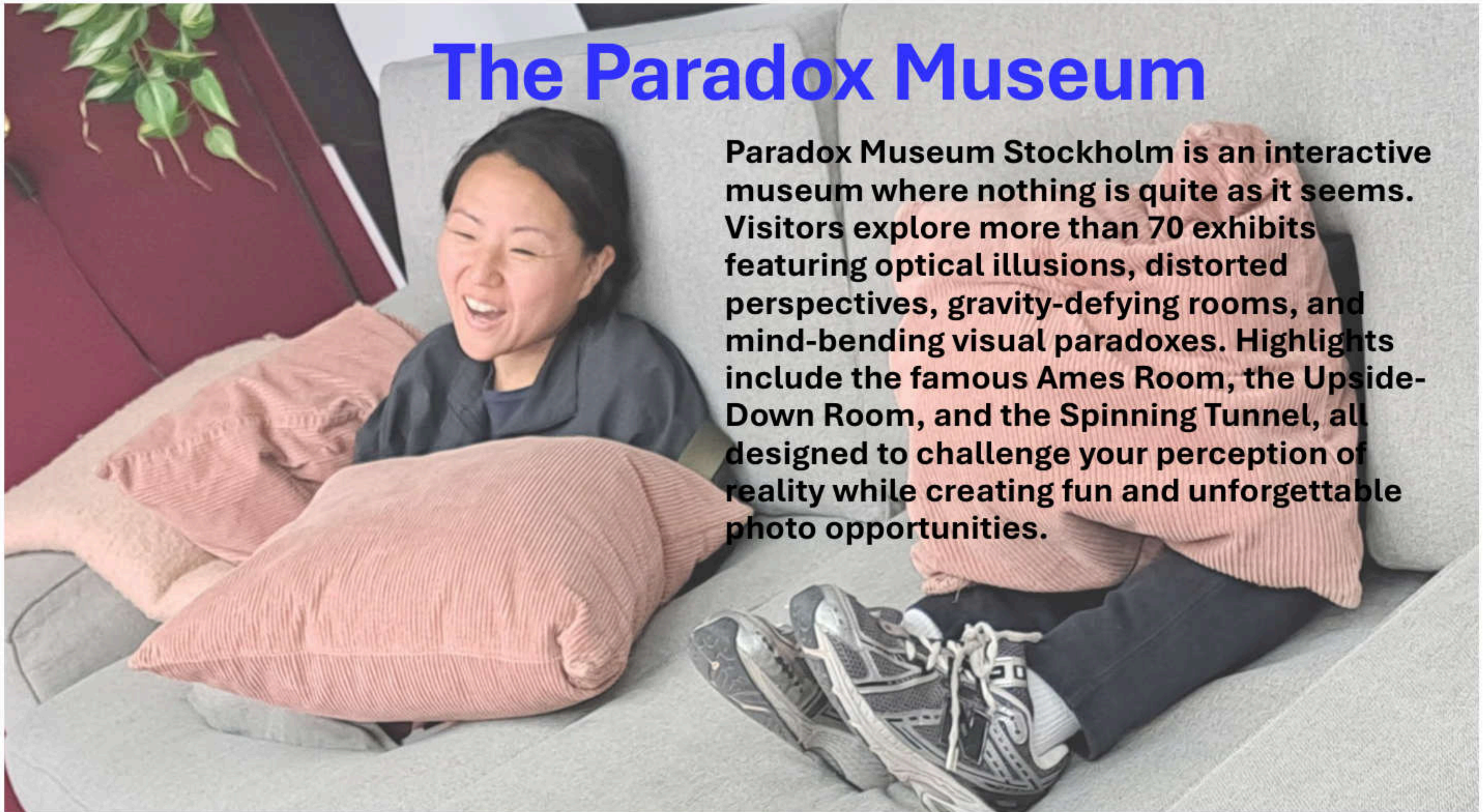
June 2, 2026

**We took the ferry from
Dottningsholm to
The Paradox
Museum located
near Hötorget and
Sergelgatan in the
central district of
Norrmalm, which
occupies the
northern part of
central
Stockholm.**



The Paradox Museum

Paradox Museum Stockholm is an interactive museum where nothing is quite as it seems. Visitors explore more than 70 exhibits featuring optical illusions, distorted perspectives, gravity-defying rooms, and mind-bending visual paradoxes. Highlights include the famous Ames Room, the Upside-Down Room, and the Spinning Tunnel, all designed to challenge your perception of reality while creating fun and unforgettable photo opportunities.



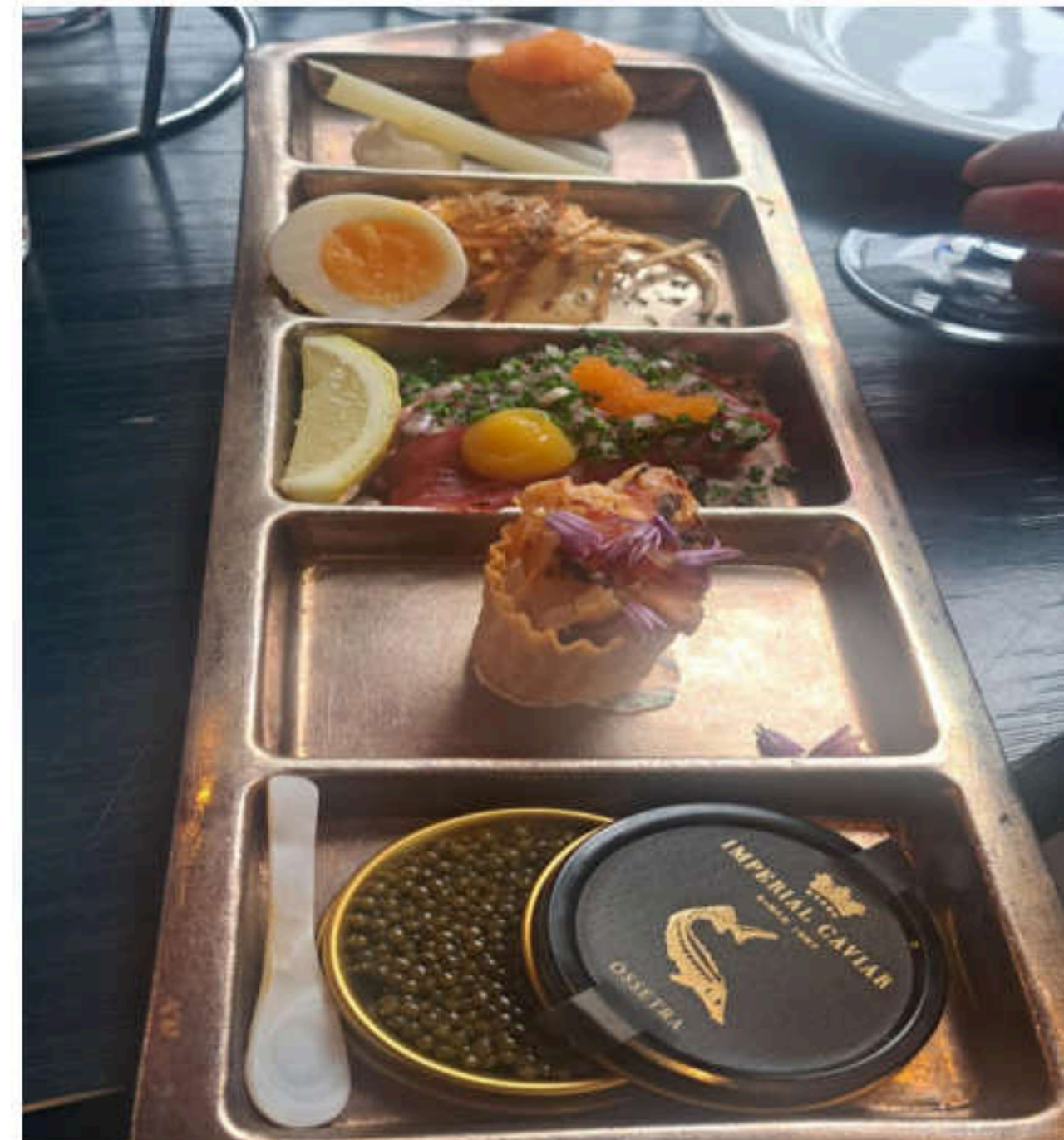


Sturehof Restaurant

After the Paradox Museum, we walked to Sturehof in central Stockholm for a wonderful outdoor dinner. The restaurant's famous 3- or 5-assiette tasting menu introduced us to classic Swedish dishes, including several excellent herring selections. We managed to squeeze in some oysters too!

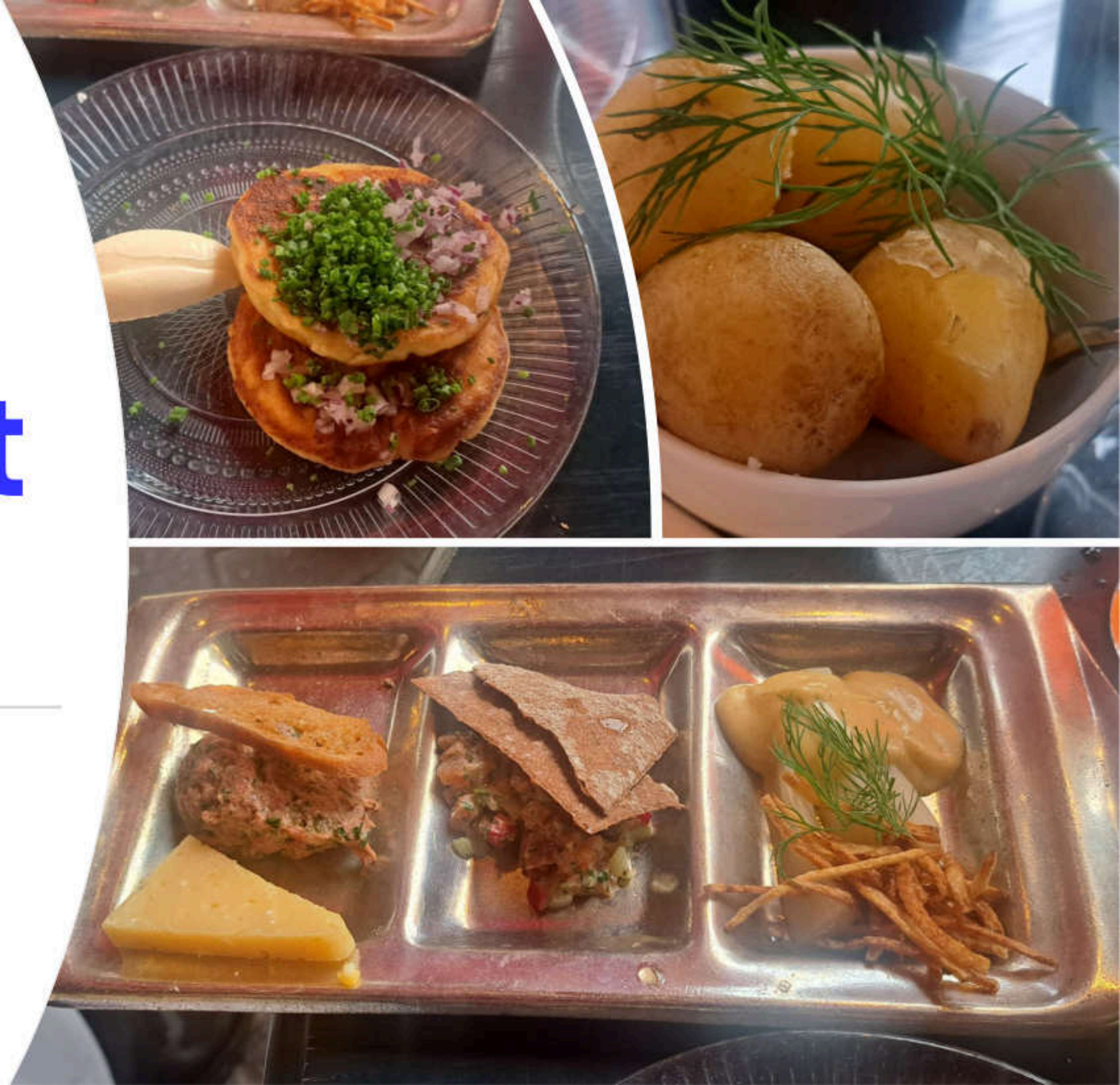


3- or 5-assiette Swedish
tasting selection
including herring.

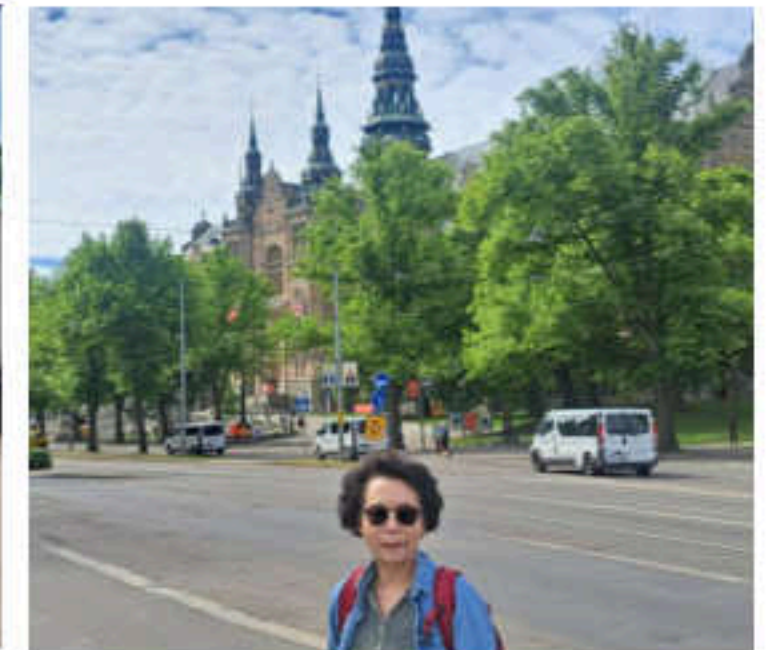


Sturehof Restaurant

Stockholm,
Sweden



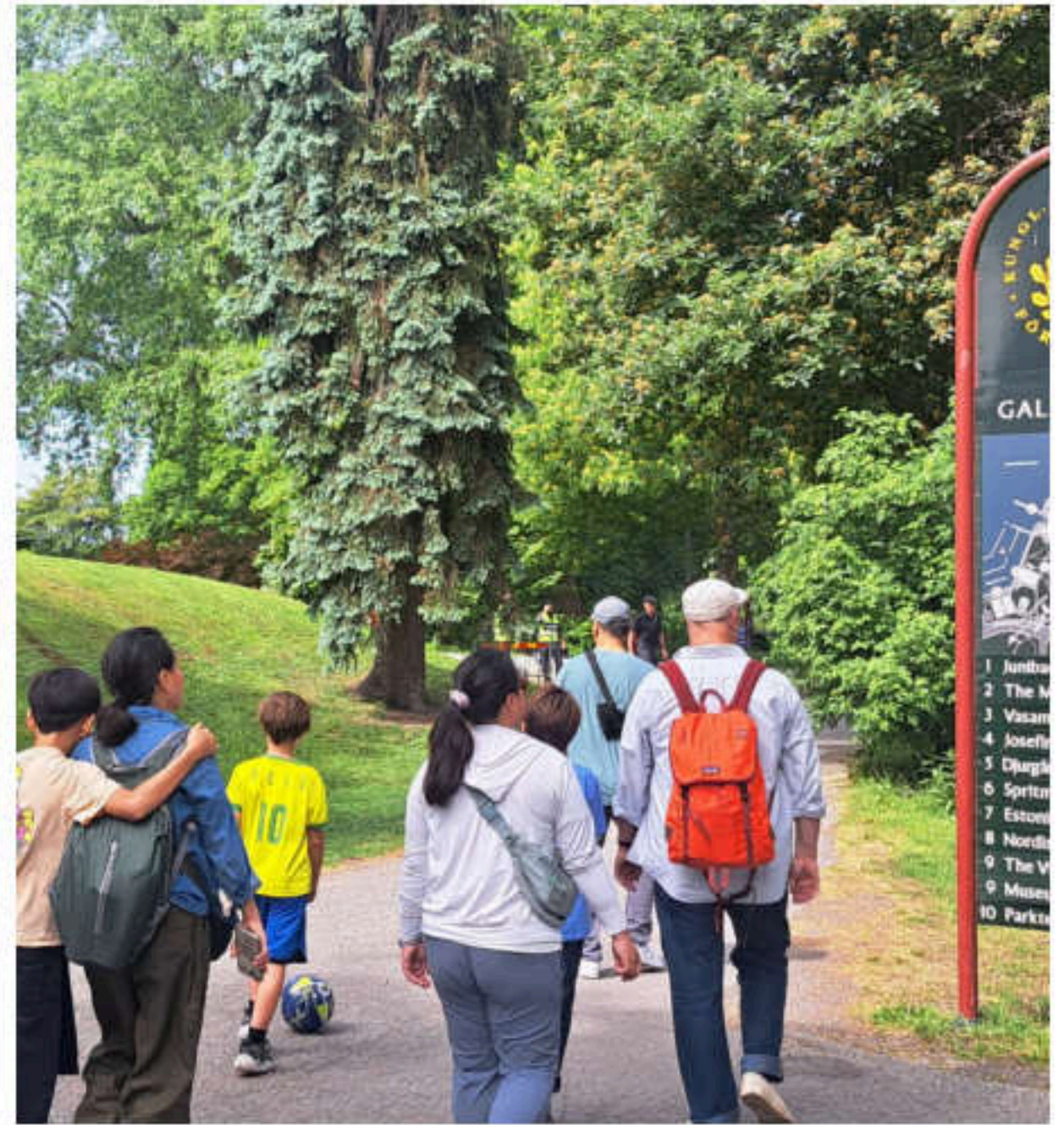
June 3, 2026



We are off to Djurgården one of Stockholm's most famous islands home to many of the city's major museums and attractions, including:

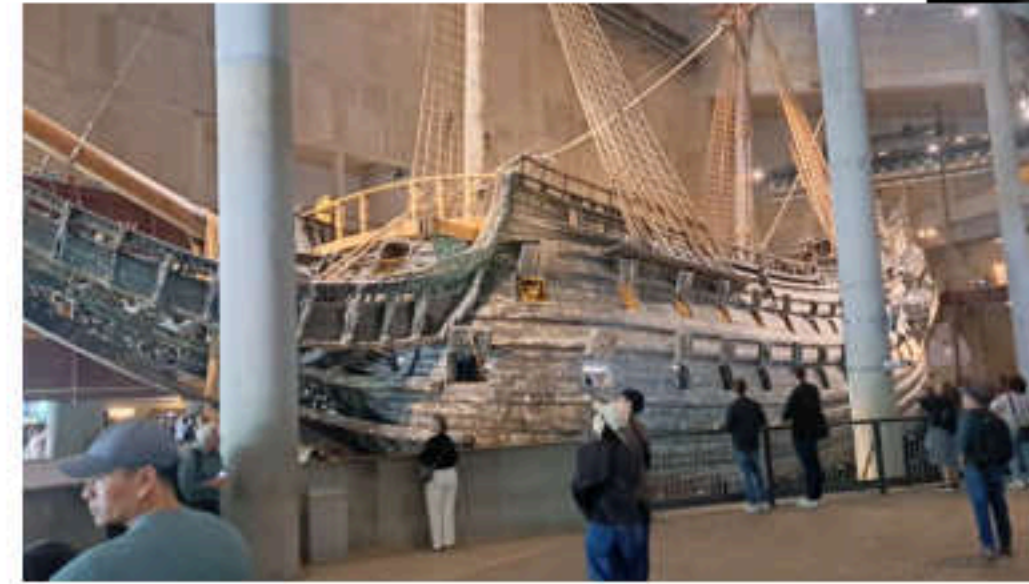
- Vasa Museum (the preserved 17th-century warship Vasa)
- ABBA The Museum
- Skansen (the world's oldest open-air museum)
- Nordic Museum
- Viking Museum
- Junibacken (Astrid Lindgren/Pippi Longstocking museum)





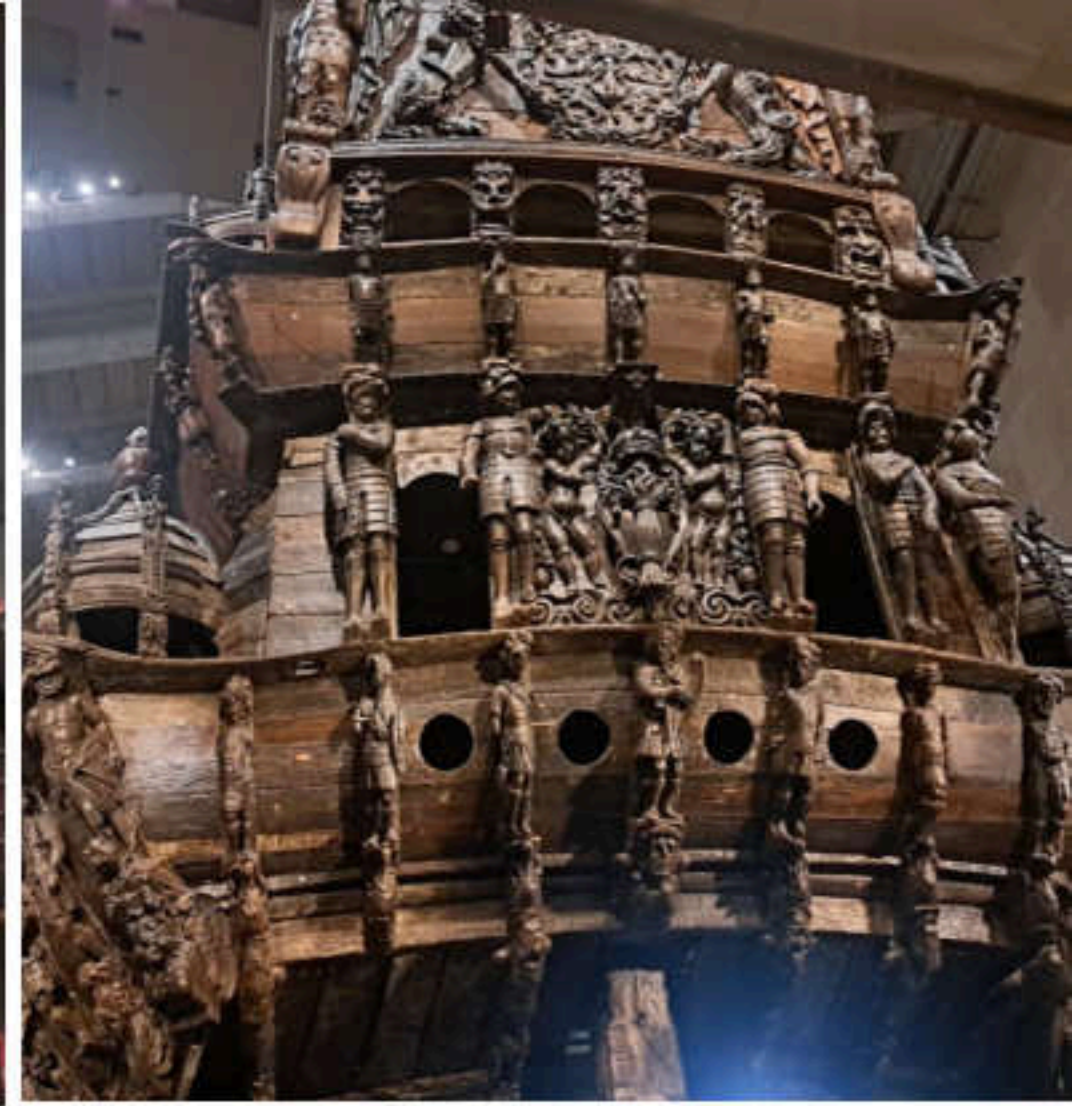
Heading to the Museums

The Vassa (Wassa) Museum



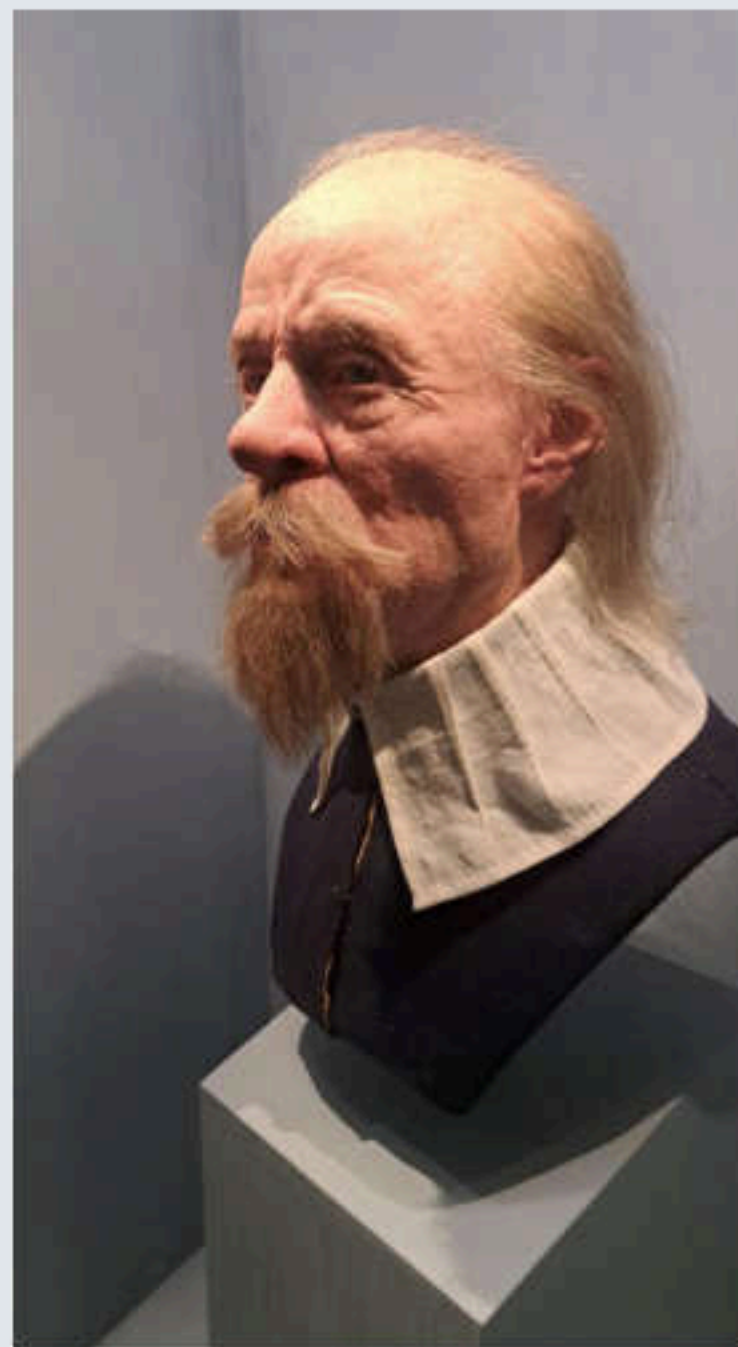
The Vasa is a remarkably preserved 17th-century Swedish warship that sank on its maiden voyage in 1628 and was recovered 333 years later, providing an extraordinary window into life in the Swedish Empire.

Vassa Museum



**Incredible carvings on
the side of the ship.**

The Captain of the Ship



The man we call Johan

- 30–50 years old
- About 163 cm tall
- Blue eyes
- Blond hair
- Found scattered in the hold
- DNA analysis showed genetic predisposition for wet earwax, normal body odour, and susceptibility to norovirus

Johan's remains were found scattered about in the hold, farthest down in the ship. The researchers believe he fell through a hatch in one of the decks above and was unable to get out.

Johan was one of the oldest on board. He might be "old" captain Hans Jonsson — the only one of the dead whose name we know. The captain had served in the navy for almost 20 years and had commanded in both Russia and France.

The Vassa





From Vassa we go to Skansen

Skansen Living History Museum

Skansen is famous for being the world's oldest open-air museum, founded in 1891. It recreates Swedish life from different regions and time periods with:

- Historic farmhouses and village buildings moved from around Sweden
- Costumed interpreters demonstrating traditional crafts and trades
- Working blacksmiths, glassblowers, bakers, and other artisans
- Traditional Swedish gardens and farms
- Scandinavian animals such as elk, reindeer, bears, and wolves





Skansen

Glass blowers in action



Skansen

Typical Swedish middle-class house
early 1900's



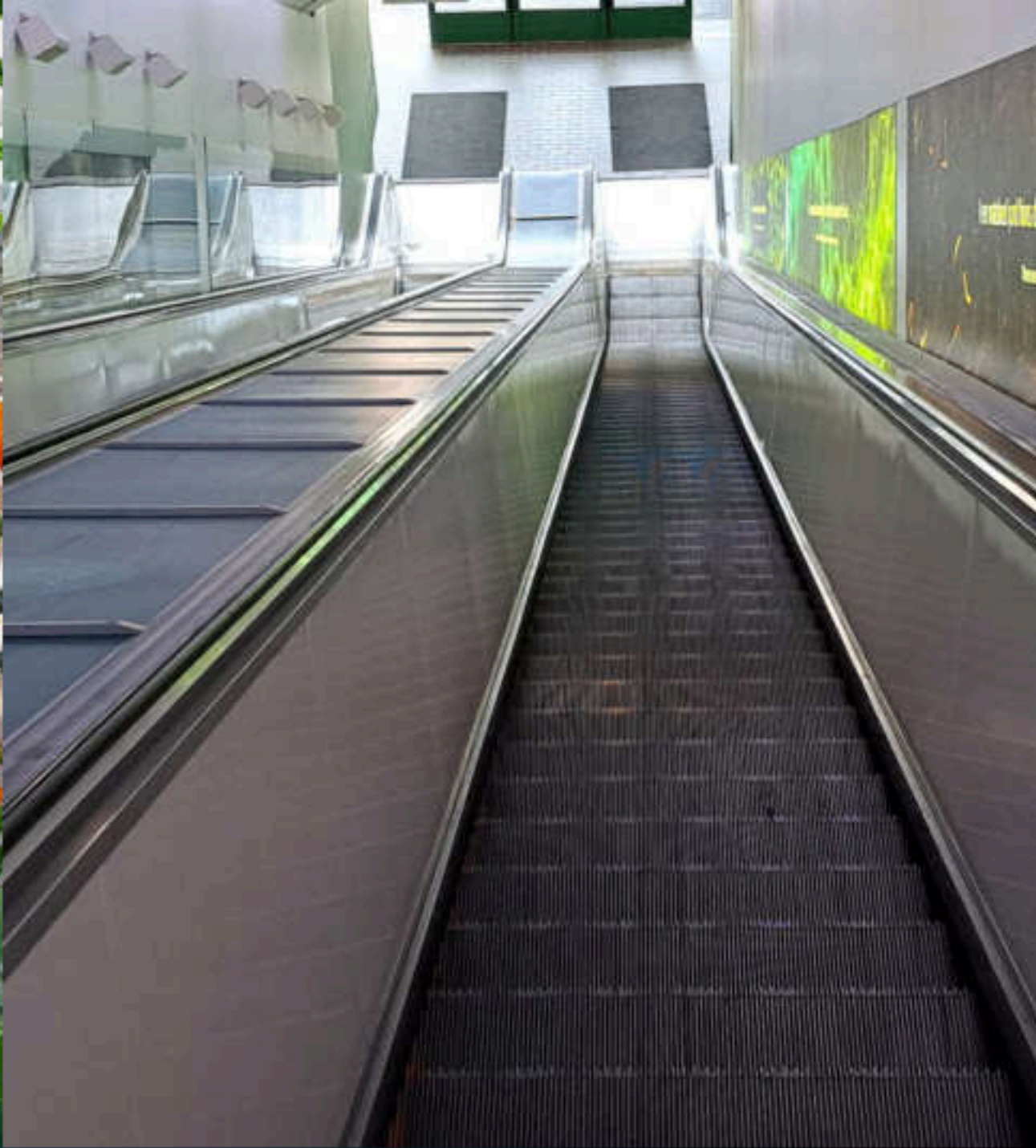


Dinner at Lisa Elmqvist Restaurant

Lisa Elmqvist began as a fish and seafood business in the 1920s and has grown into one of Stockholm's best-known seafood restaurants and fish markets. It is especially known for:

- Fresh fish and shellfish
- Traditional Swedish seafood dishes
- Herring, salmon, shrimp dishes, and seafood platters
- A long-standing recommendation in the Michelin Guide
- A location inside Stockholm's historic food hall

I really wanted to try the Swedish oysters from the Baltic sea, but they only have them a tlunch time.



Back to our Hotel
After a nice day at the
museums



Sweden vs Greece – June 4, 2026

Strawberry Arena, Stockholm



Sweden vs Greece

June 4, 2026



At the end of regulation Sweden looked like they had won 2-1. I thought the game was over! But the officials added 5 minutes to the game for no reason I understand. The result was Greece scored and it ended up a 2-2 tie. I don't understand soccer!





June 5, 2026

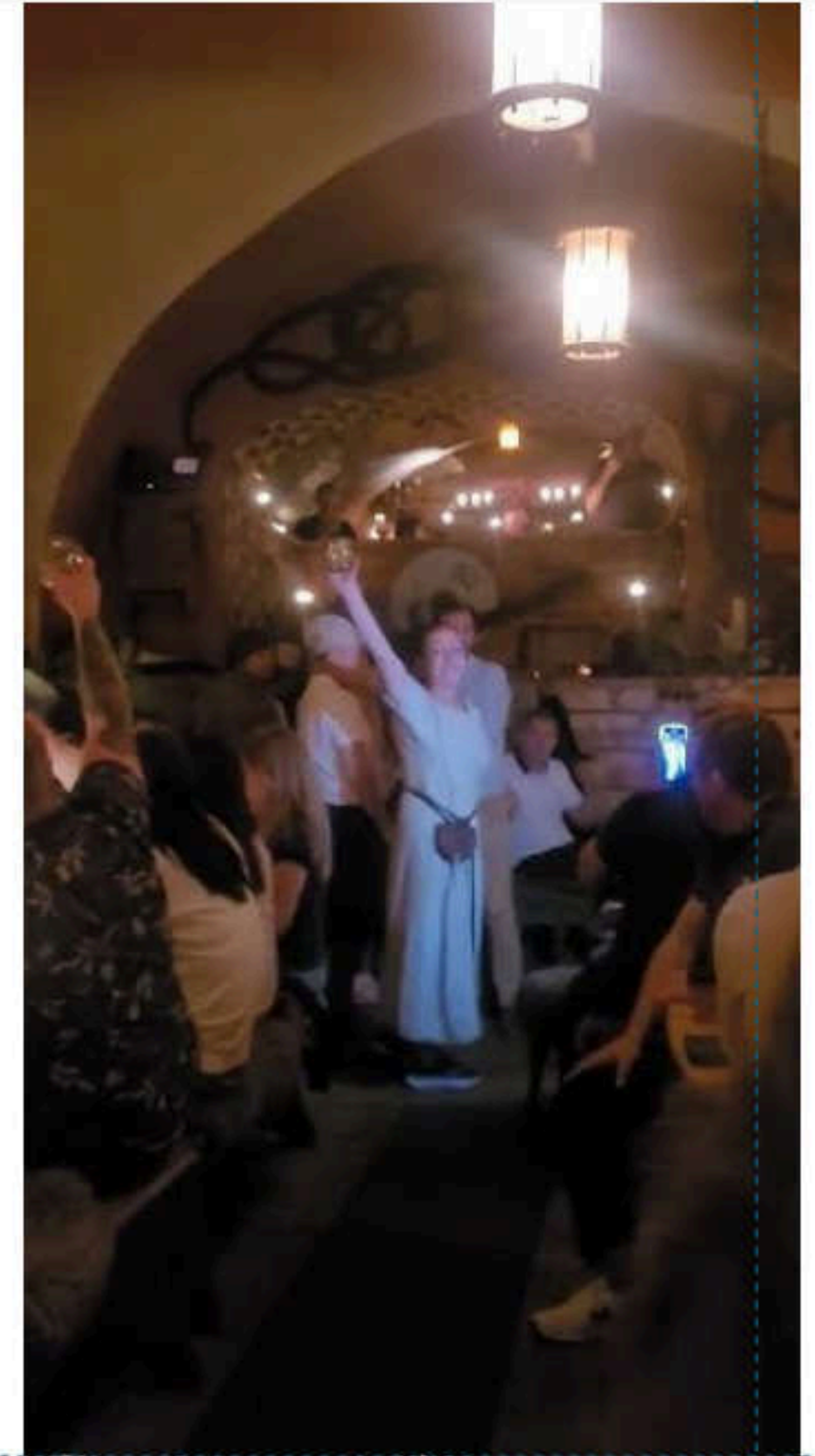


We are on our way back to Gamla Stan, the old city of Stockholm to meet Johan, my second cousin once removed. Johan's father, Jack, who died just before we came to Sweden, was my second cousin. In Swedish, Jack was my syssling. Jack's grandfather was my grandmother's brother.



Meeting with Johan

We met Johan for dinner at Aifur, a Viking-themed restaurant in Stockholm's Gamla Stan. The evening began with a unique tradition: each arriving guest was loudly announced to the room, and everyone welcomed them by enthusiastically pounding on the tables, creating a festive atmosphere that set the tone for a memorable meal.



Johan





Tour of Gamal Stan

During dinner Johan told us all about our family history. Then after dinner Johan took us on a guided tour of Gamal Stan.



Why is a Cannon Ball Stuck on the Side of a Building in the Town Square of Gamal Stan?

A cannonball embedded in a wall on Stortorget recalls Sweden's struggle for independence from Denmark. Legend says it was fired during Gustav Vasa's siege of Stockholm in 1521 and narrowly missed the Danish king Christian II, though historians now believe the cannonball was placed in the wall centuries later as a memorial to that historic victory.



Runestone in the Wall

While giving us a tour of Gamla Stan, Johan showed us this Viking Age runestone built into the wall of a historic building. Carved more than a thousand years ago, these runestones provide a remarkable link to the people, culture, and history of medieval Scandinavia.





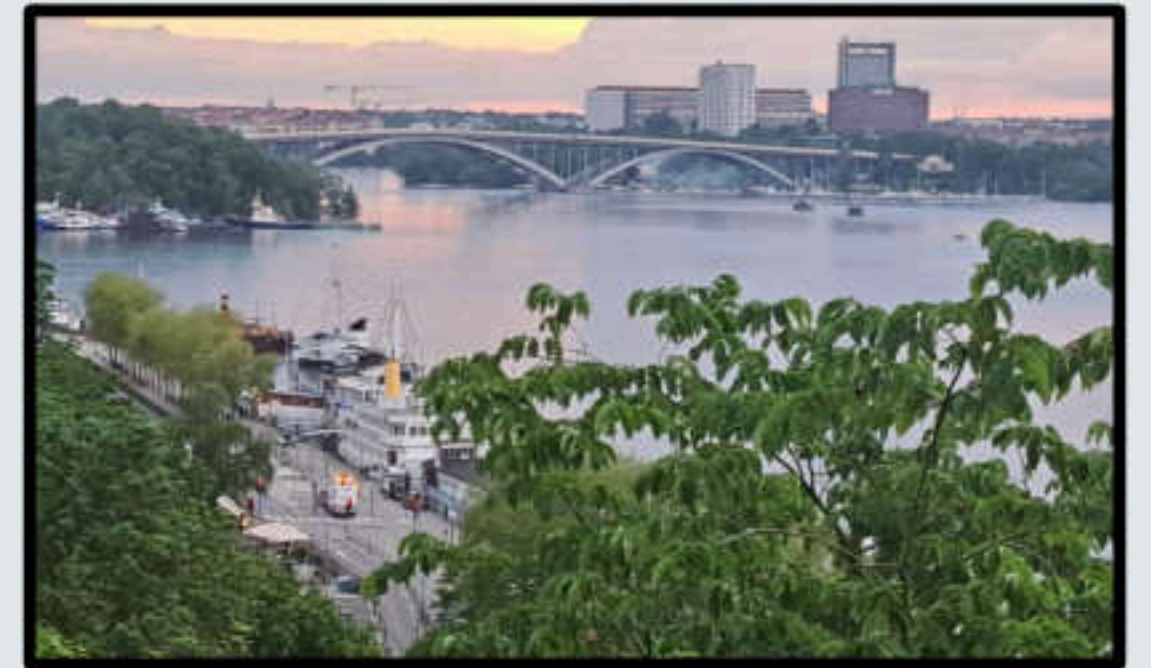
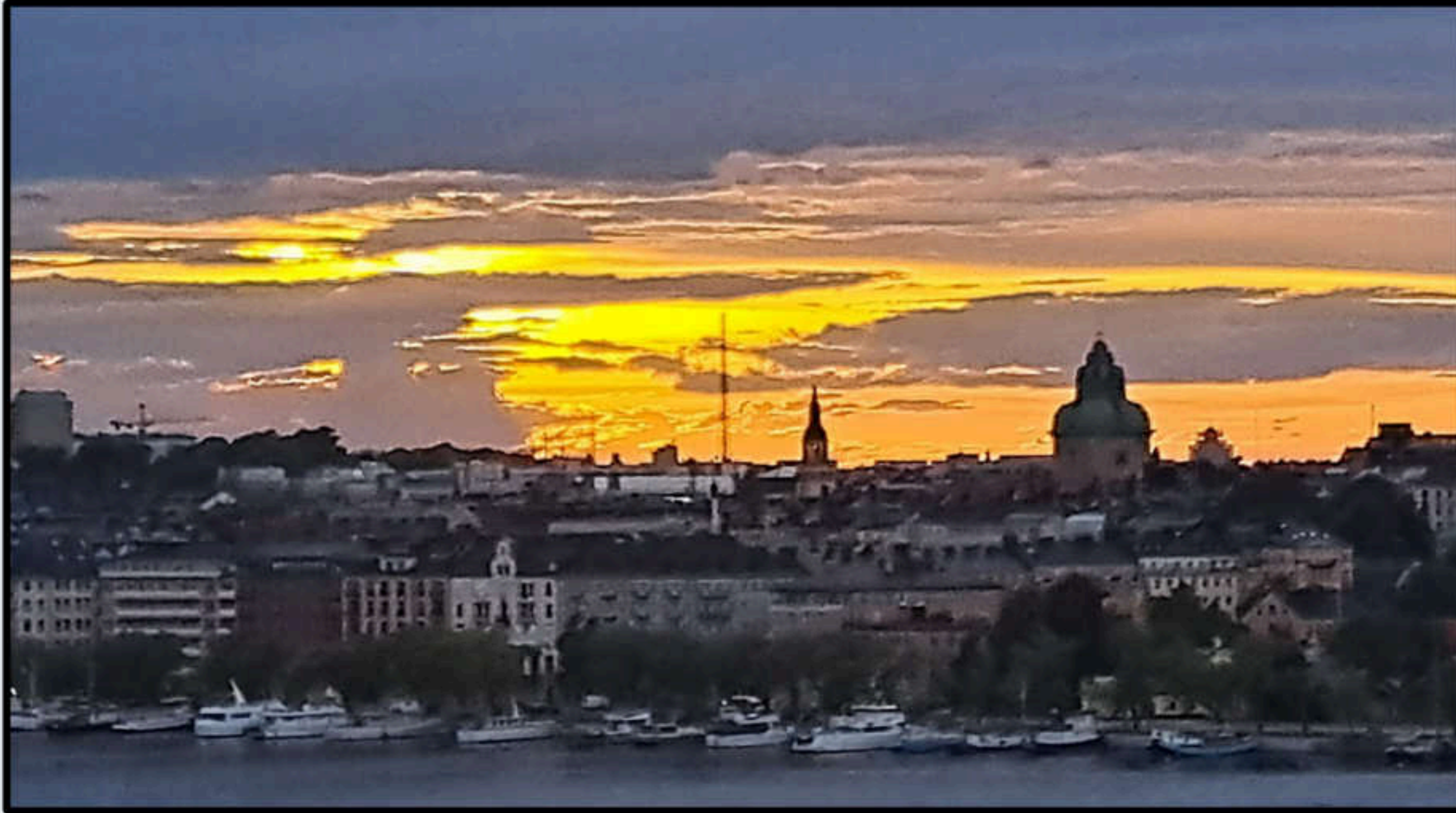
Riddarholmen

Johan then led us on foot across a bridge to Riddarholmen, a small island known for its beautiful waterfront views and historic architecture. He explained that only a handful of people have residential addresses on the island today, making it one of Stockholm's most picturesque yet least populated neighborhoods.



View from Riddarholmen

View from Riddarholman





Avgående tåg - Train departures					16:19
Tåg	Till	Nr	Spår	Anmärkning	
16:08 Göteborg	11	SJ Snabbtåg			
Tåg 441	Karlskrona Skövde Halmstad				
16:19 Moheda	12a	SJ Snabbtåg			
Tåg 541	Norrköping Linköping Malmö Naxos				
16:22 Umeå C	4	SJ Snabbtåg			
Tåg 580	Gävle Sundsvall C Örnsköldsvik				
16:36 Linköping	13a	SJ InterCity			
Tåg 277	Flemingsberg Södertälje S Norrköping				
16:37 Uppsala	3	Mälartåg			
Tåg 848	Kristinehamn Mörå				
16:41 Nyköping	16a	Mälartåg			
16:51 Duved	17b	SJ Snabbtåg			
16:54 Arboga	13a	Mälartåg			
7:11 Uppsala	19b	Mälartåg			
7:14 Göteborg	16	SJ Regional			
7:22 Norrköping	15a	Mälartåg			
7:31 Gävle	17b	SJ InterCity			
7:37 Uppsala	3	Mälartåg			
7:44 Mora	5	SJ InterCity			

Ankommande tåg - Train arrivals					16:17
Tåg	Från	Nr	Spår	Anmärkning	
15:56 Karlstad	16:17	18a	SJ		
Tåg 634	Kristinehamn Hallsberg Karlshamn				
16:14 Norrköping	16:15	15a	M		
Tåg 236	Kumla Norrköping Vagnhärad				
16:16 Borlänge	16:38	5	S		
Tåg 21	Borlänge Åresta Krybo Sala Uppsala				
16:22 Uppsala	3				
Tåg 848					
16:28 Gävle	16:30	13a			
Tåg 277	Torp Uppsala Årlanda C				
16:43 Göteborg	16:46	19b			
16:44 Hallsberg	14b				
16:46 Uppsala	13a				

Information				
Stockholm C-Malmö/Göteborg/Karlstad				
Förändringar i tågplanen p.g.a. ett väderstille				
vid Rm. Informationen kommer att uppdateras				
eller hand på respektive avgång				

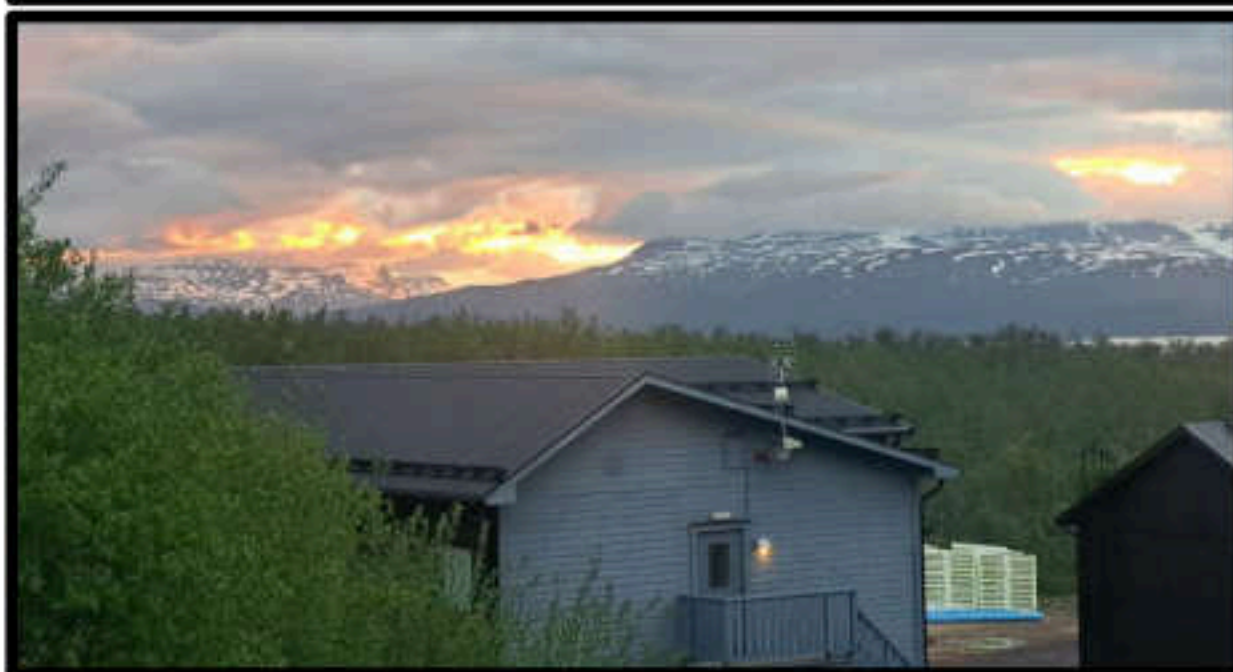
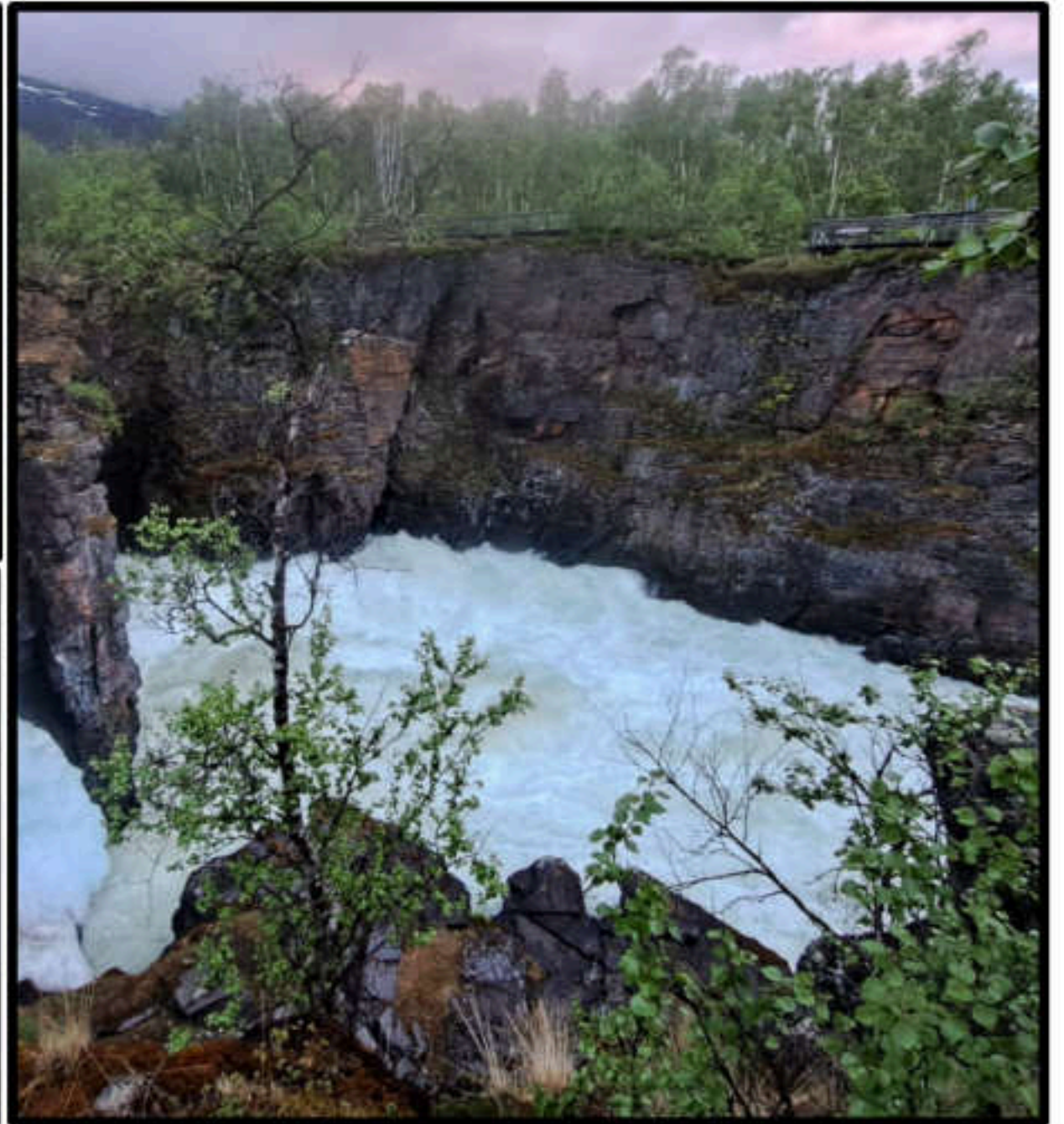
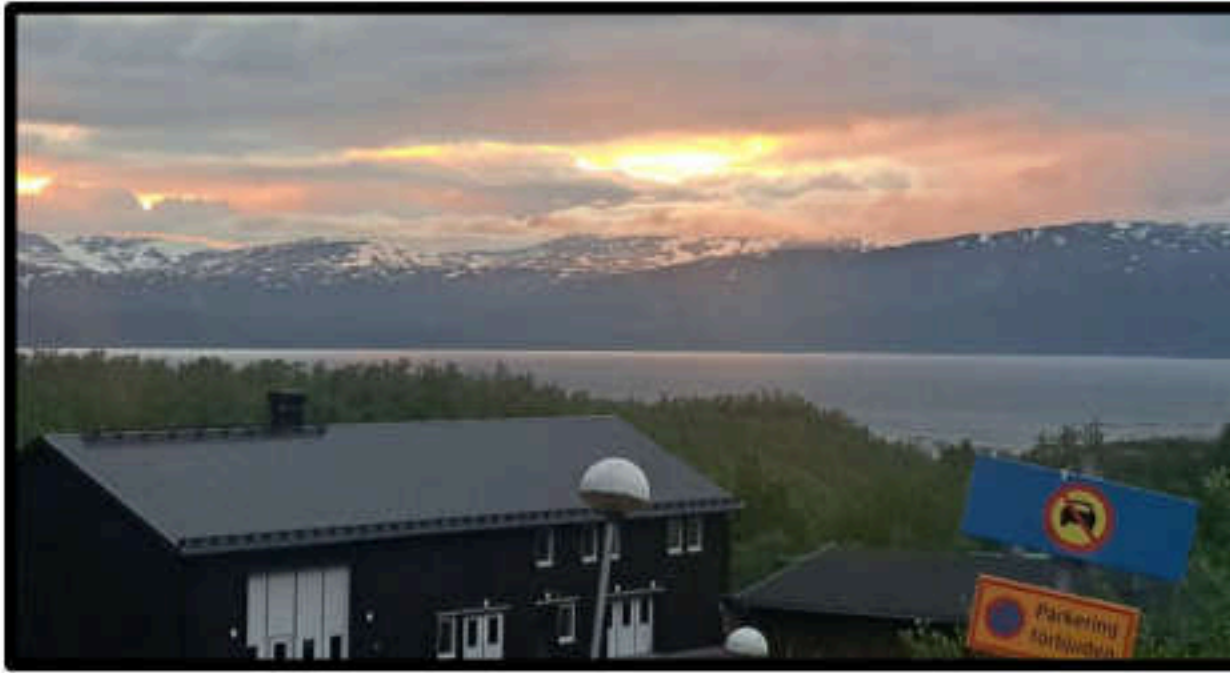
Catching the Overnight Train to Abisko

Our overnight train included three sleeper cabins each with three fold-down beds, providing a memorable way to travel through Sweden's countryside for the 18-hour trip from Stockholm to Abisko National Park located above the Arctic Circle. Even with a full 8-hours sleep, we had plenty of time to enjoy the scenery and the dining car.



Scenery on the way to Abisko

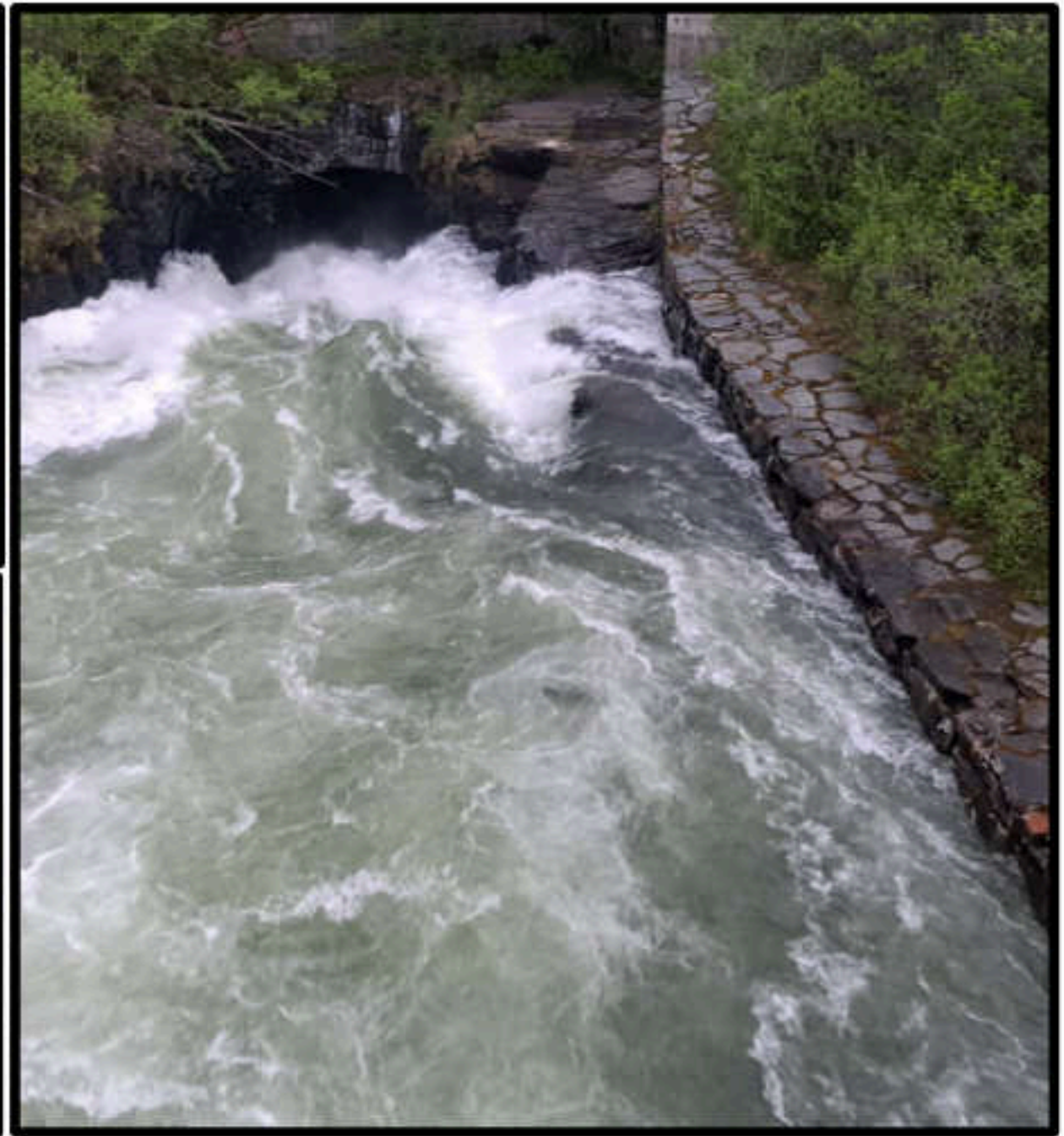




Midnight Sun at Abisko National Park

Midnight Sun at Abisko National Park





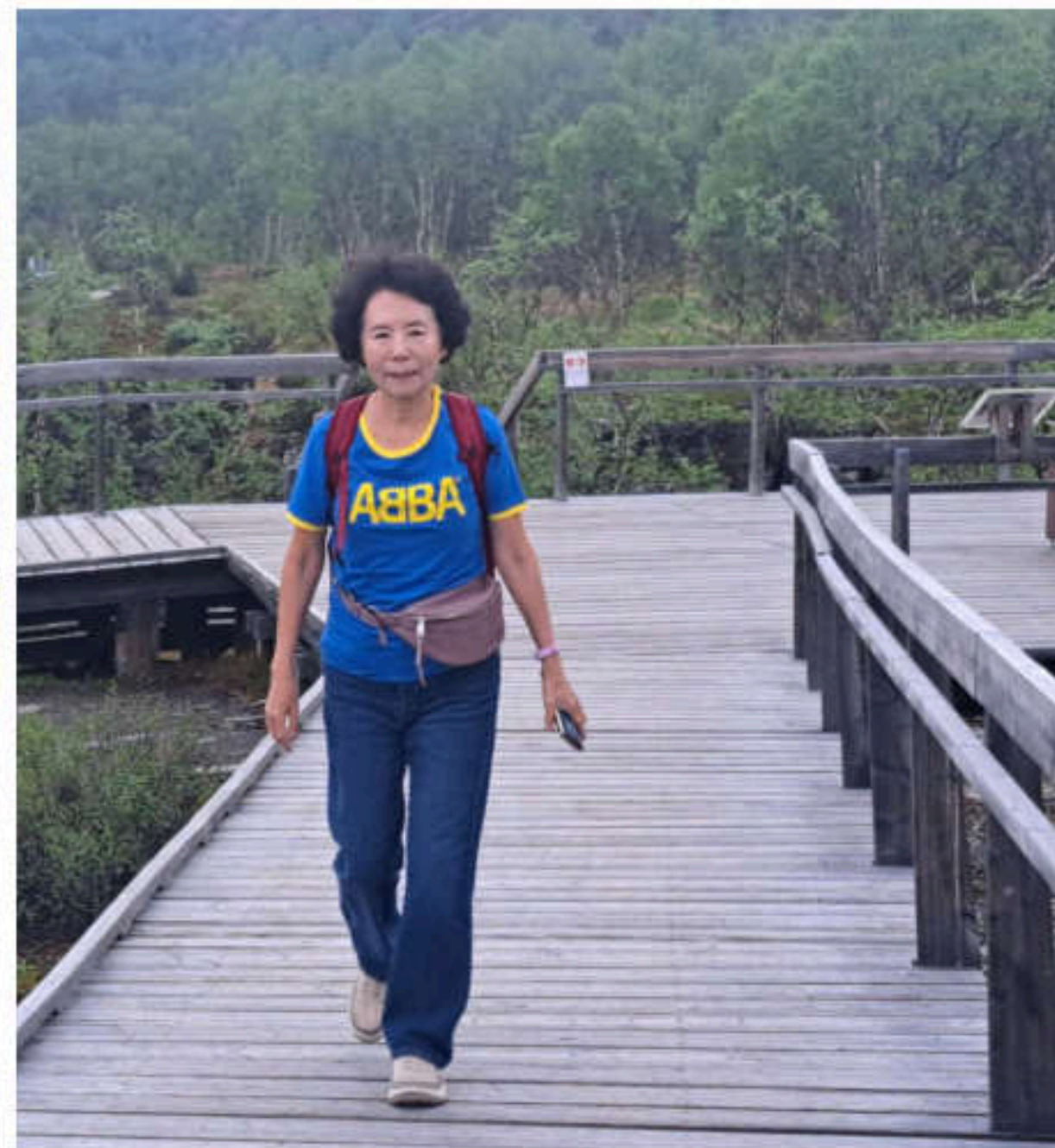
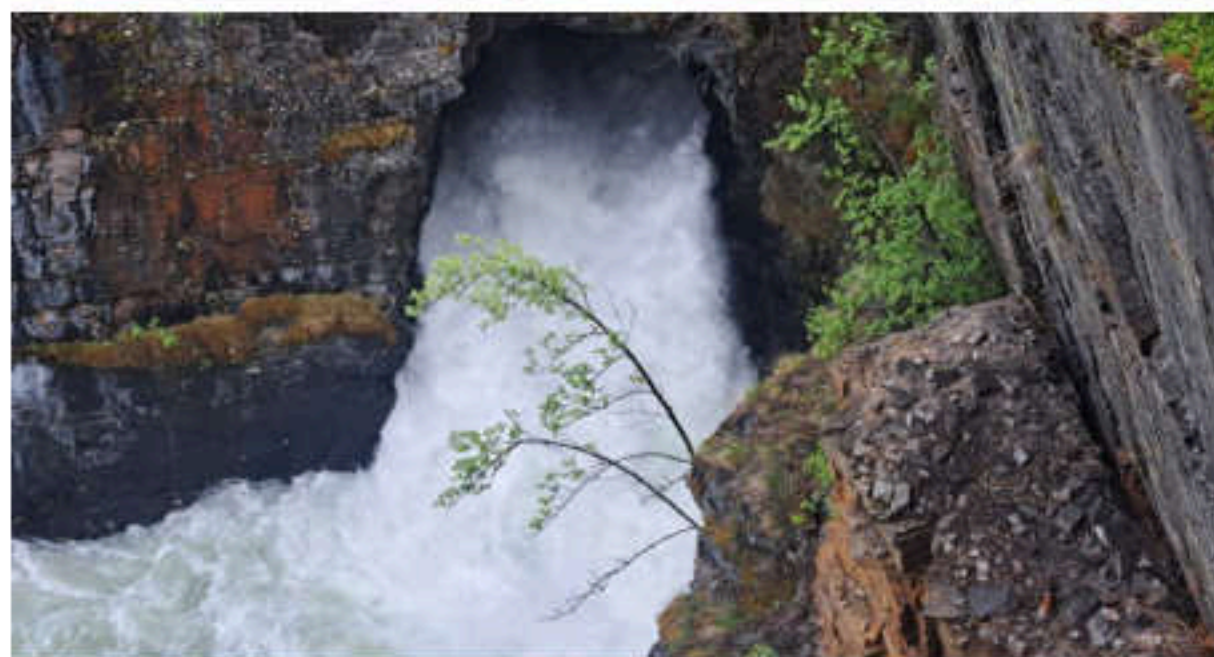
Waterfalls in the Midnight Sun

Early Morning Hours of Monday July 8, 2026



12 Hours Later it is Noon at Abisko National Park

Everybody is out to explore, but it doesn't look much different from Midnight!



Noon time at Abisko Noational Park

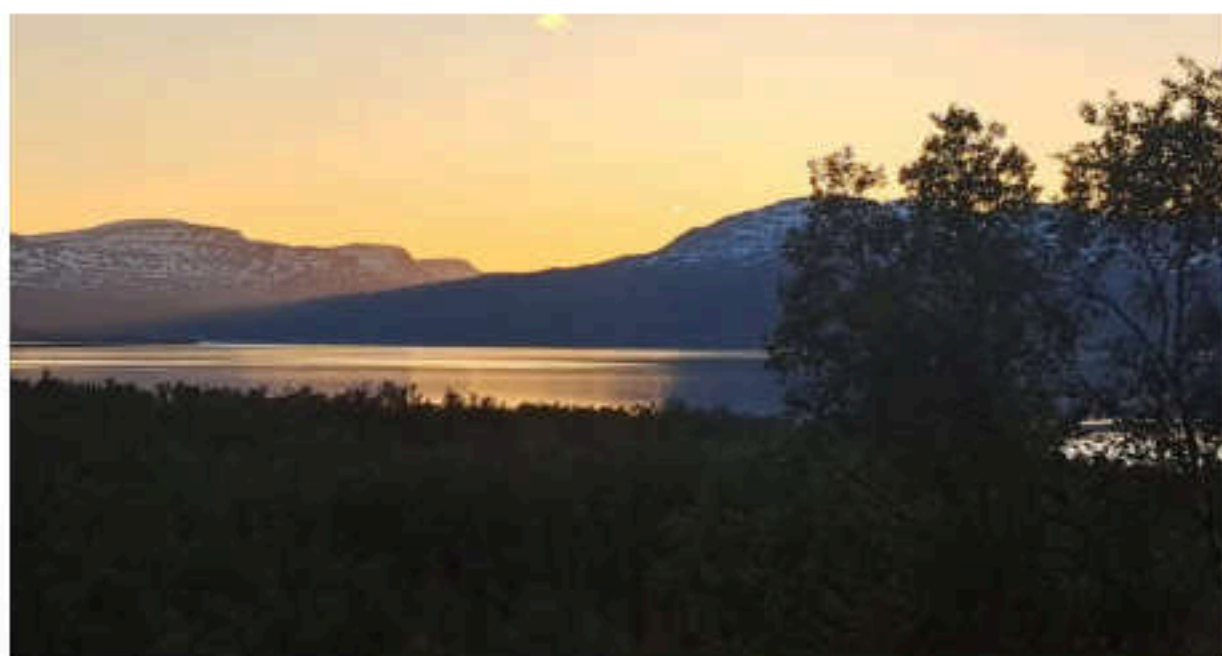
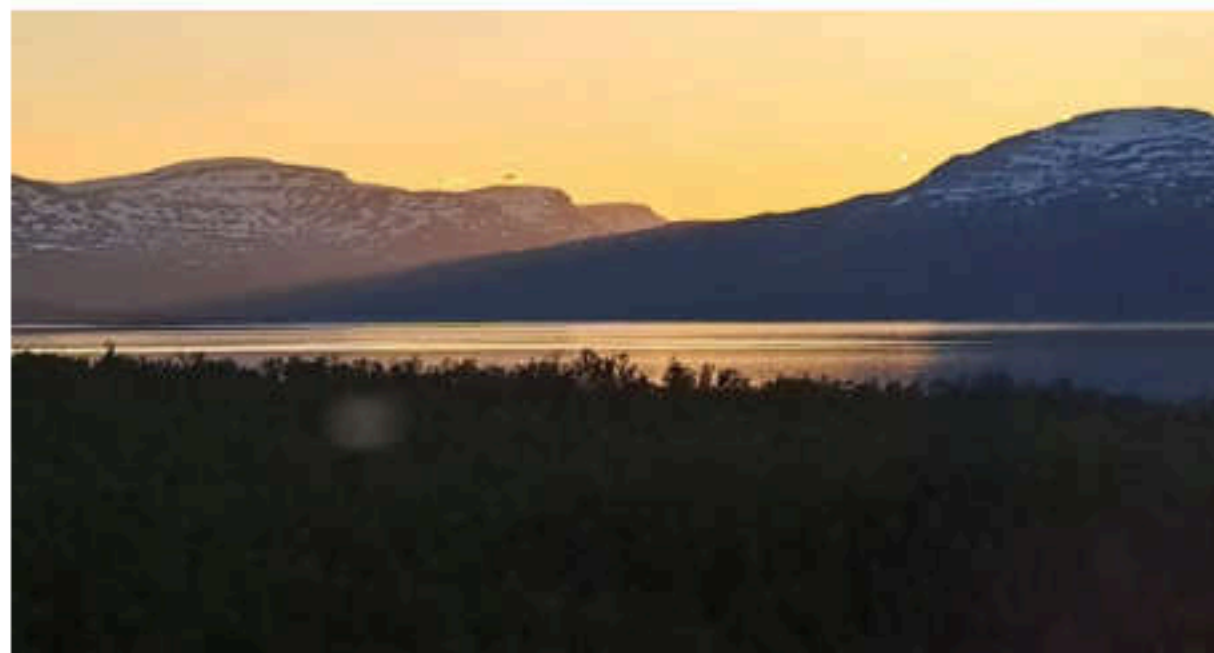
Noon Time at Abisko National Park





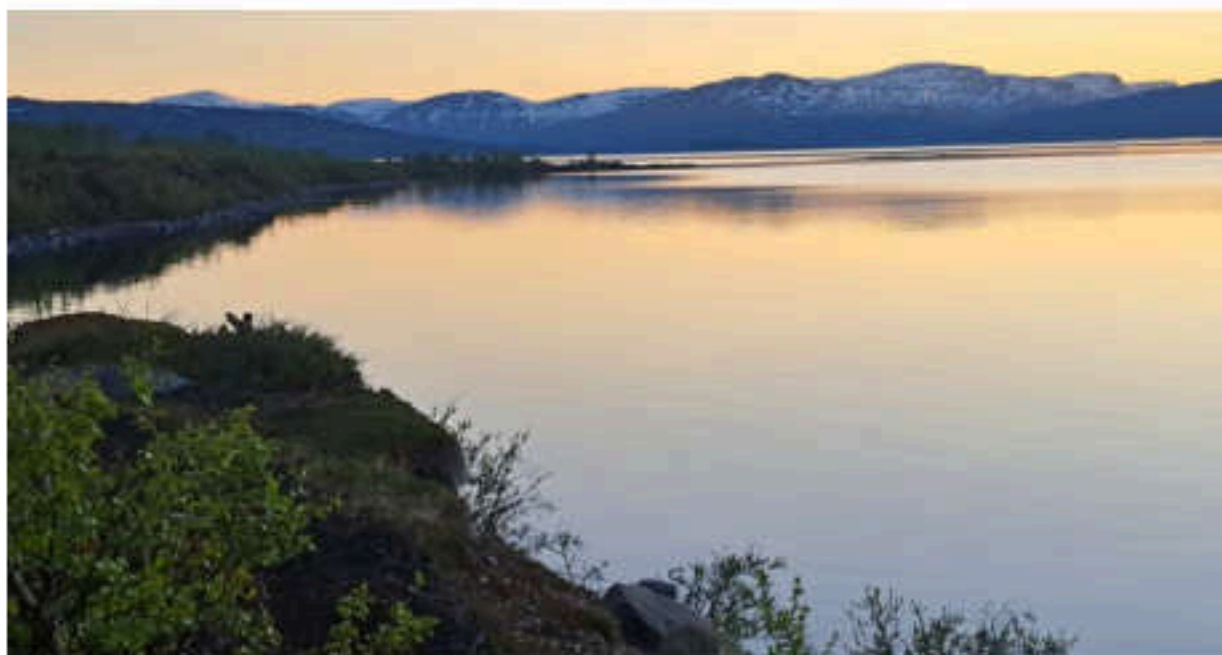
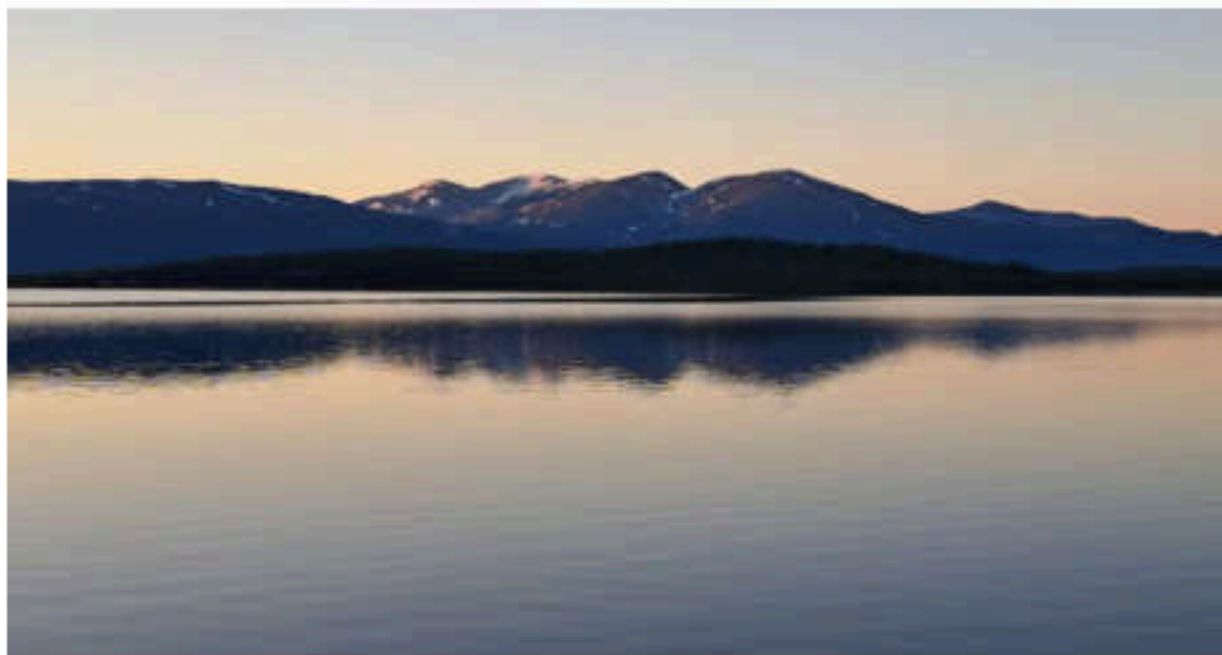
Breakfast, Lunch and Dinner at STF Hotel

There is only one option to eat at Abisko and this is it!

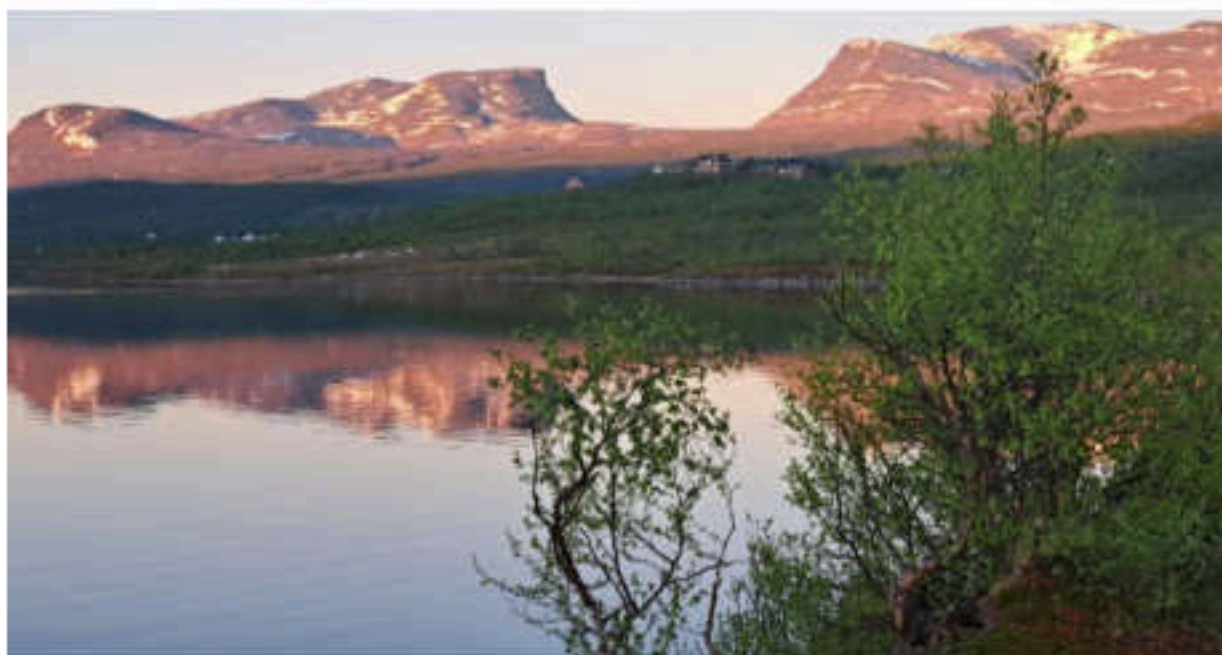
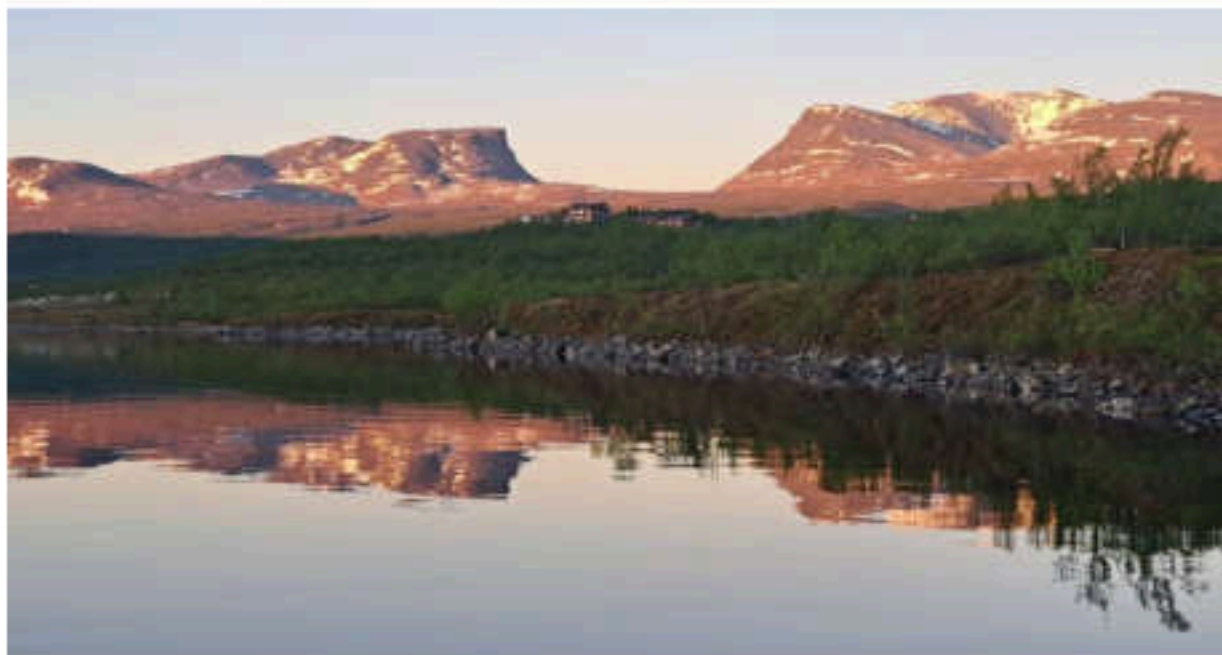
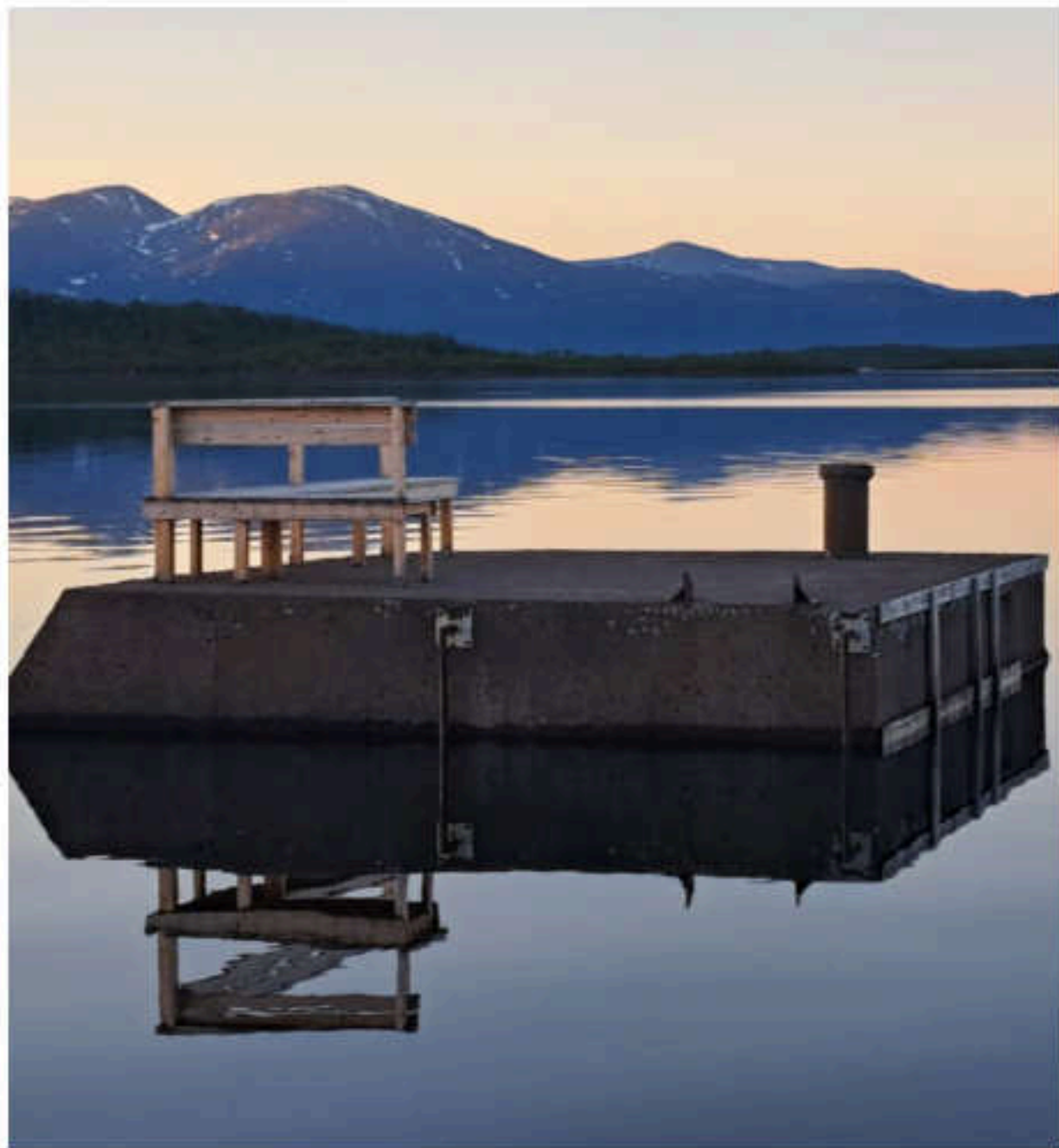


Time for More Midnight Sun

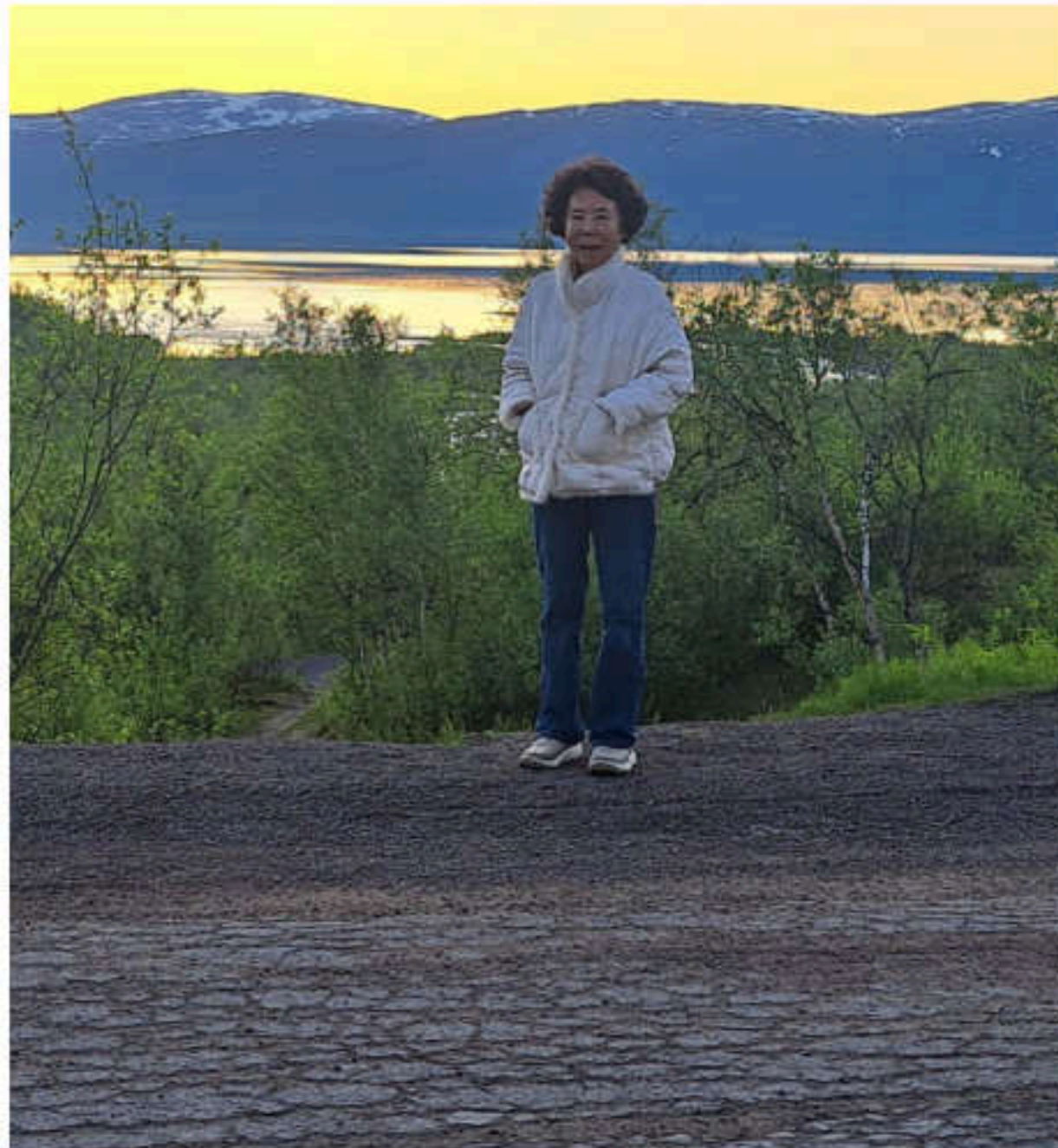
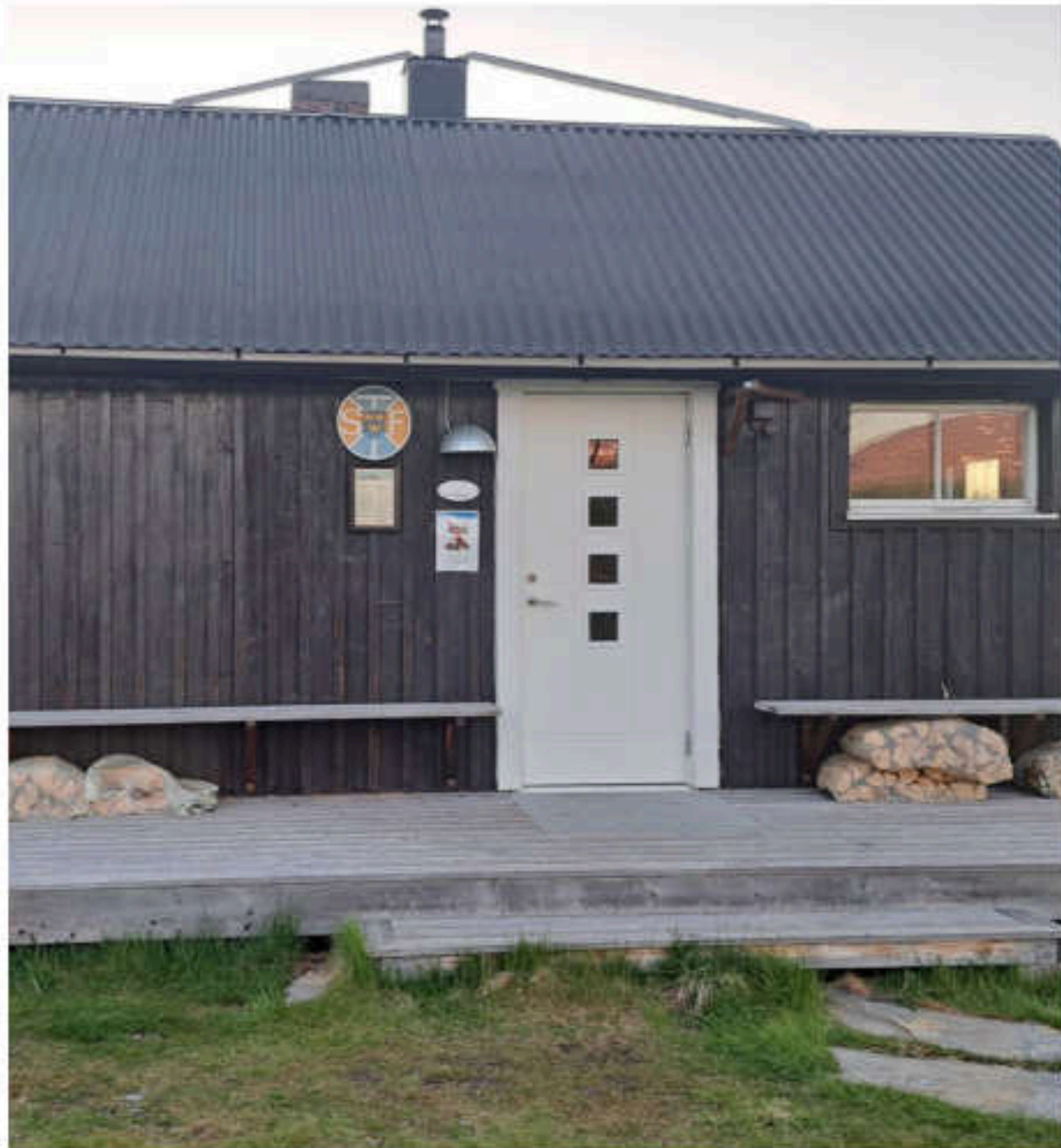
Out just before and after Midnight on
Monday June 8 Through Tuesday June 9



More Midnight Sun



More Midnight Sun



More Midnight Sun

On the Way Home

We left Abisko on June 10 and went back to Stockholm. Then on June 11 we left Stockholm for the USA. What a wonderful 80th birthday present from my son and daughter and their families.

